



Union soldier's cap

The narrow-brimmed hat known as a “forage cap” was worn by most Union troops. Union forces had standardized, mass-produced clothing and gear; the Confederates usually had to improvise.

the Army, takes office as President of the Confederate States of America. On April 12, Confederate troops fire on Union-held Fort Sumter in the harbor at Charleston, South Carolina. The first major battle of the war, First Bull Run, fought in Virginia, ends in a Union defeat.

1862 On April 6–7, A Union army under Ulysses S. Grant is nearly overwhelmed at Shiloh, Tennessee. A Union offensive up the peninsula between the James and York rivers, aimed at taking the Confederate capitol, Richmond, ends in defeat, but Union naval forces succeed in capturing New Orleans, Louisiana. In June, Robert E. Lee takes command of the Confederacy’s Army of Northern Virginia. Lee invades Maryland, but is halted at Antietam. Congress passes the Homestead Act, which grants 640 acres of western land to any head of household who settles on it for five years

1863 On January 1, the Emancipation Proclamation is issued by Abraham Lincoln, freeing slaves in the Confederacy. At the end of the Civil War, slavery is abolished by the 13th Amendment to the Constitution. The 14th Amendment of 1868 gives former slaves US citizenship, while the 15th Amendment of 1870 guarantees their right to vote. American Indians have to wait until 1924 to become citizens. Lee again invades the North, and the Army of Northern Virginia and the Army of the Potomac clash at Gettysburg, Pennsylvania (July 1–3), which ends in a Union victory. Rioting breaks out in New York City over the new draft law, which introduces conscription.

1864 In the spring, Union commander Grant begins an offensive against Richmond. In September, the Union’s western army, under General William T. Sherman, captures Atlanta, Georgia. The victory helps Lincoln win reelection to a second term in the presidential election in November. Sherman sets out on a “March to the Sea,” taking Savannah on the Atlantic coast (December 21).

1865 A peace conference in February fails when the Union refuses to accept

independence for the Confederacy. At the beginning of April, Grant resumes the offensive toward Richmond.

1865 On April 15 Abraham Lincoln is assassinated; vice president Andrew Johnson takes over as president.

1866–77 Reconstruction of the South as former Confederate states are slowly allowed back into the Union. An amnesty is granted to former Confederates who pledge allegiance to the Union.

1866 Ku Klux Klan founded to oppose civil rights for former slaves.

1867 Russia sells Alaska to the US for \$7.2 million.

1868 For the first time a sitting president, Andrew Johnson, is impeached (tried) by Congress, for trying to obstruct Reconstruction. The measure passes the House of Representatives but does not achieve the necessary Senate majority.

1869 The Union Pacific and Central Pacific railroads meet at Promontory Point, Utah, thus completing the first transcontinental railroad. A ceremonial golden spike is driven into the railroad.

1869 Wyoming becomes the first US territory to grant women the vote.

1870 US population reaches 40 million.

1870 John D. Rockefeller founds the Standard Oil Company of Ohio, soon to become America’s largest oil company.

1871 The city of Chicago, almost entirely built of wood, is destroyed in a massive fire that kills several hundred people, makes 90,000 homeless, and destroys some \$200 million worth of property. After the fire, the city is rebuilt in stone and steel, and the world’s first skyscrapers are constructed.

1876 Alexander Graham Bell patents the telephone. In 1885 Bell forms the American Telephone and Telegraph Co.

1876–77 The Great Sioux War breaks out on the northern Great Plains after the Sioux resist gold prospectors entering their lands. Although they massacre General George Custer and 200 troops at Little Bighorn, they are eventually forced to surrender.

1882 Immigration controls limit entry of Chinese, as well as “convicts, lunatics, and other undesirables.”

1885 Grover Cleveland becomes the first Democratic president since James Buchanan in 1857. Although he loses the office in 1889, he wins reelection in 1893, the first and only time that a US president has served nonconsecutive terms.

PRESIDENTS OF THE UNITED STATES				
	PRESIDENT	PARTY	DATES	VICE PRESIDENT
1	George Washington	None	1789–97	John Adams
2	John Adams	F	1797–1801	Thomas Jefferson
3	Thomas Jefferson	DR	1801–09	Aaron Burr 1801–05 George Clinton 1805–09
4	James Madison	DR	1809–17	George Clinton 1809–12 No vice president 1812–13 Elbridge Gerry 1813–14 No vice president 1814–17
5	James Monroe	DR	1817–25	Daniel D. Tompkins
6	John Quincy Adams	DR	1825–29	John C. Calhoun
7	Andrew Jackson	D	1829–37	John C. Calhoun 1829–32 No vice president 1832–33 Martin Van Buren 1833–37
8	Martin Van Buren	D	1837–41	Richard M. Johnson
9	William Henry Harrison	W	1841	John Tyler
10	John Tyler	W	1841–45	No vice president
11	James K. Polk	D	1845–49	George M. Dallas
12	Zachary Taylor	W	1849–50	Millard Fillmore
13	Millard Fillmore	W	1850–53	No vice president
14	Franklin Pierce	D	1853–57	William R. King 1853 No vice president 1853–57
15	James Buchanan	D	1857–61	John C. Breckinridge
16	Abraham Lincoln	R	1861–65	Hannibal Hamlin 1861–65 Andrew Johnson 1865 No vice president
17	Andrew Johnson	D/NU	1865–69	Schuyler Colfax 1869–73 Henry Wilson 1873–75 No vice president 1875–77
18	Ulysses S. Grant	R	1869–77	William A. Wheeler
19	Rutherford B. Hayes	R	1877–81	Chester A. Arthur
20	James Garfield	R	1881	No vice president
21	Chester A. Arthur	R	1881–85	Thomas A. Hendricks 1885 No vice president 1885–89
22	Grover Cleveland	D	1885–89	Levi P. Morton
23	Benjamin Harrison	R	1889–93	Adlai E. Stevenson
24	Grover Cleveland	D	1893–97	Garret A. Hobart 1897–99 No vice president 1899–1901
25	William McKinley	R	1897–1901	Theodore Roosevelt 1901 No vice president 1901–05
26	Theodore Roosevelt	R	1901–09	Charles W. Fairbanks 1905–09
27	William Howard Taft	R	1909–13	James S. Sherman 1909–12 No vice president 1912–13
28	Woodrow Wilson	D	1913–21	Thomas R. Marshall
29	Warren G. Harding	R	1921–23	Calvin Coolidge
30	Calvin Coolidge	R	1923–29	No vice president 1923–25 Charles G. Dawes 1925–29
31	Herbert Hoover	R	1929–33	Charles Curtis
32	Franklin Delano Roosevelt	D	1933–45	John N. Garner 1933–41 Henry A. Wallace 1941–45 Harry S. Truman 1945
33	Harry S. Truman	D	1945–53	No vice president 1945–49 Alben W. Barkley 1949–53
34	Dwight D. Eisenhower	R	1953–61	Richard M. Nixon
35	John F. Kennedy	D	1961–63	Lyndon B. Johnson
36	Lyndon B. Johnson	D	1963–69	No vice president 1963–65 Hubert Humphrey 1965–69
37	Richard M. Nixon	R	1969–74	Spiro T. Agnew 1969–73 No vice president 1973 Gerald Ford 1973–74
38	Gerald Ford	R	1974–77	No vice president 1974 Nelson A. Rockefeller 1974–77
39	Jimmy Carter	D	1977–81	Walter Mondale
40	Ronald Reagan	R	1981–89	George Herbert Walker Bush
41	George H. W. Bush	R	1989–93	J. Danforth Quayle
42	Bill Clinton	D	1993–2001	Albert Gore, Jr.
43	George W. Bush	R	2001–09	Dick Cheney
44	Barack Obama	D	2009–	Joseph Biden
45	Election due November 2012			

F Federalist, DR Democratic–Republican, D Democratic, R Republican, W Whig, NU National Union